# Adam Bawatneh

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Website | GitHub | LinkedIn

## Research Interests

Social reasoning and Theory of Mind, mental-state representations, and how AI systems use social context.
Interested in exploring these questions across language and multimodal settings, including generative AI and agent systems.

## Education

**University of Central Florida** — Orlando, Florida
Ph.D. in Computer Science — Aug 2025 – May 2029 (expected); GPA: 4.00/4.00

**University of Central Florida** — Orlando, Florida
B.S. in Computer Science — Aug 2022 – May 2025

## Selected Publication

**Adam Bawatneh***, Sagar Sapkota, Amrit Singh Bedi, Santu Karmaker, and Mubarak Shah.
"OmniToM: Benchmarking Theory of Mind in LLMs via Explicit Belief Modeling."
*NeurIPS 2026*, Evaluations & Datasets Track. Project | Benchmark

## Research Experience

**Graduate Research Assistant, University of Central Florida** — May 2026 – Present
Conduct AI research and contribute to government proposal development, including IARPA-focused proposals.

**Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, University of Central Florida** — May 2023 – May 2025
Led labs and mentored students in C, Python, and Java courses serving more than 1,500 students.

## Selected Research Projects

**OmniToM: Social Reasoning Evaluation for LLMs** — Oct 2025 – Present

- Led development of a benchmark spanning 895 stories and coordinated quality review with 11 annotators across more than 1,100 hours.
- Tested commercial and open models via Azure OpenAI, Anthropic API, and Google Vertex AI.

**CADS: Context-Aware Detection of Specialized Language** — Summer 2026 – Present
Mentored Valerie Lopez during the summer REU; the project continues in the lab.

- Developed and evaluated an NLP pipeline that combines complementary text signals to identify specialized language.
- Evaluated transfer across domains and languages to assess where the approach generalizes.

**BIAS-101: Demographic Bias in Video Action Recognition** — Jan 2025 – Apr 2025
Screened 85,000+ videos, curated 2,000+ clips, and analyzed demographic representation in action recognition data.

**DETECT: Real-Time Gaze and Facial-Signal Analysis** — Aug 2024 – Apr 2025
Led a 6-member team to build and deploy a real-time gaze and facial-signal system. Project evaluation reported 80%+ gaze-tracking accuracy.

## Academic Service

Conference reviewer: NeurIPS, AAAI, and ACL.

## Technical Skills

**Research:** Social reasoning, Theory of Mind, research design, benchmarking, experimental analysis
**AI:** Natural language processing, machine learning, language models, model evaluation, responsible AI
**Programming:** Python, C/C++, Java, JavaScript, Go, SQL
**Model Platforms:** Azure OpenAI, Anthropic API, Google Vertex AI, Hugging Face
**Cloud and HPC:** Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud, NSF ACCESS
**Tools:** Git/GitHub, Linux, Docker, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, LaTeX